can define a constant and its fixed value as long as you do not give the constant the same name as another range in the workbook. Defined constants do not show up in the workbook, but they are defined using the Define Name dialog box just like a range, shown below. In the 'Refers to' box, type the equal sign and then the numeric value of the constant. You can then use the name of the constant in formulas. Now you can use 'Com_Rate' to refer to the commission rate in formulas.

Most worksheets use labels to identify rows and columns for the reader's convenience. For example, in this worksheet there is a row named 'Renuka' and a column named 'Sales'. Excel can use these labels in a couple of ways to identify cell and range contents. To identify Renuka's sales, we can enter the formula '=Sales Renuka' (or '=Renuka Sales'). In fact, if we had two columns named 'Sales', one under 'Current' and one under 'Prior', we could identify Renuka's sales as '=Current Sales Renuka' and as '=Prior Sales Renuka'. These are called 'stacked labels'.

It is important to note that by default Excel does not recognise labels in formulas. To use labels in formulas, go to **Tools > Options** and then select the 'Calculation' tab. Under 'Workbook Options', check 'Accept labels in formulas'. Labels will then be available for use in formulas on the worksheet where the labels appear. When enabled, labels work like relative cell references.

In the example, the formula that will calculate Renuka's commission is now simply '=(Sales Renuka)*Rate'.

Alternatively, you could have entered =(Sales Renuka)*Com_Rate to use the constant. Since '(Sales Renuka)' is a relative cell reference, you can copy the formula down the 'Commission' column and it will update automatically.

Thus far, we have only identified or named individual cells. A range, however, can consist of many cells. These cells may be contiguous (all in the same rows, columns, or rectangular area) or